

Product Brief: Hestia

Executive Summary

Hestia is not a maid bureau.

Every evening, millions of Kenyan households carry an invisible load: dishes in the sink, laundry piling on the chair, no proper food in the house, a floor not cleaned since last week. This is not a staffing problem. It is domestic overwhelm — and it is the real product Hestia exists to solve.

Hestia is a home-relief service. We help busy Kenyans restore order, cleanliness, and food in their homes when life gets too fast for the home to keep up. We are not a bureau that connects workers and disappears. We are not a listing platform. We are the care layer — staying involved, understanding each home's specific pain stack, and providing trusted recurring support until the home feels human again.

The product is not the worker. The product is the feeling:

"I came home, and life felt lighter."

Kenya's domestic services market is large (2M+ workers), high-pain, and structurally broken by distrust. No existing operator sells relief. Bureaus sell access. Platforms sell discovery. Hestia sells the outcome — and builds the trust infrastructure to deliver it repeatedly. Starting manually with founding homes, Hestia will learn the real shape of domestic pain before any platform is built.

The Problem

Kenya's middle class is growing faster than its home infrastructure can keep up.

Dual-income couples, busy young professionals, single parents, diaspora returnees, bachelors — they all share the same invisible crisis: the home becomes a second job they cannot do. Dishes accumulate. Clean clothes run out. Proper food disappears. The backlog compounds until Sunday becomes a chore marathon, or a guest visit triggers a panic clean.

This is not about needing a maid. The deeper pain is:

"My life is moving faster than my home can keep up."

The emotional cost is real: shame when guests arrive unannounced, fatigue from carrying the home alone after work, the hollow feeling of eating badly because the kitchen is a mess, the low-grade stress of knowing the disorder is waiting for you at home.

What Kenyans currently do when overwhelmed:

- Call a mama fua for laundry, but nothing else
- Use a bureau to hire a cleaner who may not return
- Ask a relative — unreliable and relationship-costly
- Order takeaway — solves food, not the home
- Do nothing — normalize the backlog until it breaks them

Every one of these is an incomplete solution. None of them understands the home. None of them comes back reliably. None of them creates the feeling:

"I don't have to carry this alone anymore."

The structural failures of the status quo:

- Traditional bureaus earn on placement and disappear. No accountability, no relationship, no relief.
 - Digital listing platforms (Msichana.co.ke, similar) earn KES 200 per match. No follow-through, no trust verification at depth, no recurring model.
 - Word-of-mouth — the real dominant channel — is trusted but does not scale beyond your neighbour's network.
 - No Kenyan operator currently sells home relief as an outcome. They all sell access to labour.
-

The Solution

Hestia is a home-relief service that delivers recurring domestic support built around each household's specific pain stack.

The core product is not a worker. It is a restored home.

When a client works with Hestia, they are not hiring a cleaner. They are buying a feeling — relief from the domestic backlog that accumulates when life moves too fast. The service is delivered by Hestia Home Care Partners (trusted, trained, managed people) but the product is the outcome: order, cleanliness, food, and continuity.

The Three Core Feelings Hestia Creates

1. **Relief** — the mess is handled. The pile is gone. The sink is clear.
2. **Care** — the home feels touched by someone who noticed what needed doing, not just what was asked. A mother's touch.
3. **Continuity** — this is not a one-time rescue. Hestia can become part of the household rhythm.

The Service: What Hestia Does

Hestia handles the domestic backlog:

- **Cleaning** — kitchen, bathrooms, floors, surfaces
- **Dishes** — cleared, washed, reset
- **Laundry** — washing, folding, sorting, ironing
- **Simple home-style meals** — not fast food, not hotel food. Kenyan home cooking: chapati + stew, ugali + greens, rice + beef, githeri, pilau. Food that feels like home.
- **General tidy and reset** — organizing, bedding, light deep-clean elements

Not all of these in every visit. The service is shaped to the home's specific pain point. Some homes are buried in laundry. Some have no food. Some just need a kitchen reset. Hestia learns the home.

The Trial Packages (Phase 1)

Three entry options, leading with the flagship:

Option A — Hestia Home Reset (*flagship*) Full domestic reset for overwhelmed homes. Dishes, kitchen, bathrooms, floors, laundry, general tidy. Message: "*We restore the house from chaos to livable.*"

Option B — Laundry + Cleaning Relief For bachelors, young professionals, busy single-person households. Clothes washed or coordinated, folded, ironed where possible. Bedroom tidy, bathroom and kitchen clean. Message: "*Clean clothes, clean space, less stress.*"

Option C — Mother's Touch Meal + Clean Kitchen For people tired of eating badly. Simple Kenyan home meal prepared, kitchen cleaned, dishes handled, light tidy. Message: "*Not fast food. Home food.*"

The Conversion Model: Founding Homes

Hestia does not launch to everyone. Phase 1 is a manual "founding homes" programme:

- Identify households with real domestic pain through face-to-face investigation
- Offer a first trial — prove the feeling before asking for any commitment
- After the trial, if the home felt lighter, build a recurring plan around that household
- Weekly or monthly support, shaped to the home's pain stack

The pitch: *"You are not just a customer. You are helping shape what Hestia becomes."*

This reduces entry barrier, builds real trust, generates field intelligence, and creates the foundation for a subscription model — without over-promising before the service is proven.

What Makes This Different

1. We sell relief, not access. Every other player sells access to workers. Hestia sells the outcome: a home that feels restored. That is a fundamentally different product, price point, and brand promise.

2. We stay involved. Bureaus place workers and disappear. Platforms connect and move on. Hestia stays. We supervise the first visits, we follow up, we handle problems, we learn the home. The relationship is the product.

3. We understand the pain stack, not just the task. A bureau asks, "What cleaning do you need?" Hestia asks, "What piles up first when you're overwhelmed? What does it feel like to come home to that?" We are investigating domestic pain, not filling a job order.

4. We earn on every service — not every placement. Recurring model. Every visit is revenue. This funds the trust infrastructure — supervision, quality standards, worker development — that no bureau can afford because they only earn once.

5. The "mother's touch" is real differentiation. In Kenya, a home is not just a space. It is where dignity returns after the chaos outside. Hestia's service is not task completion. It is home restoration. That resonates in ways that "domestic cleaning platform" does not.

6. The platform comes after the model is proven. The platform is not Hestia. The platform is a tool Hestia will use after the manual trust loop is established. Building an app before understanding the real shape of domestic pain is a waste. Hestia learns first, builds second.

Who This Serves

Primary: The Overwhelmed Busy Professional (Nairobi) Young dual-income couples, single professionals, bachelors, 25–40. Kilimani, Lavington, Westlands, Kileleshwa. Their home has become their second job and they are losing. They do not say, "I need a maid." They say, "My house is a disaster and I have no energy to fix it." That is the door.

Secondary: The New Parent Young families — especially new mothers — where the domestic load has doubled while capacity has stayed the same. The emotional cost of domestic overwhelm is highest here. Hestia offers relief that feels maternal. High loyalty, high word-of-mouth.

Secondary: The Diaspora Returner Kenyans returning from the UK, US, Canada, Gulf. Income KES 200K+/month. They have experienced professional domestic services abroad and expect a structured, reliable model at home. High willingness to pay. Already converted — just needs to find Hestia.

Secondary: The Busy Single (Bachelor/Bachelorette) Living alone, nobody splitting the chores. The backlog compounds silently. Often eating badly because the kitchen is impossible. Laundry + cleaning + simple meal prep is the exact Hestia package for them.

Supply: Hestia Home Care Partners Not "maids." Not "workers." Not "casual labour." Hestia Home Care Partners are trained, trusted people for whom Hestia is their professional home. Hestia offers: steady work, fair payment, portable reputation, training, and a path to grow — from Partner to Senior Partner to Supervisor to Trainer. Workers depend on Hestia because Hestia gives them what no informal relationship can: dignity, consistency, and upward mobility. The relationship between Hestia and its Partners is the product's integrity.

The Trust Architecture

Trust is the business. Without it, no household opens the door.

Client trust requirements (gathered from field investigation):

- Government ID of every Partner
- Uniform or identifiable presence
- Police clearance / DCI certificate
- Supervisor involvement at first visit
- Clear pricing, no hidden costs
- Ability to be present during service
- A known, reachable founder
- Honest trial with honest feedback

Worker trust requirements (how Hestia earns Partner loyalty):

- Steady, reliable booking calendar
 - On-time payment, always
 - Protection from abusive or unfair clients
 - A profile that builds reputation over time
 - Training that improves their skill and earning
 - Senior paths: lead, supervisor, trainer
 - Identity: *"I am a Hestia Home Care Partner"* — not a random cleaner
-

Field Investigation Framework

Phase 1 is as much a research operation as a service launch. Every client visit is structured to answer four questions:

1. **Does domestic overwhelm exist at real scale?** (Pain confirmation)
2. **Do people want relief — not just a worker?** (Concept validation)
3. **Will they trust Hestia enough to let someone in?** (Trust threshold)
4. **Will they pay repeatedly — not just once?** (Subscription viability)

The investigation structure follows a ten-step door-to-leave meeting:

- Permission to ask
- Describe their real busy week
- Map the pain stack (what piles up first)
- Surface the emotional cost
- Learn current coping behaviour
- Reveal the Hestia concept
- Make it concrete (the picture)
- Ask: does this solve a real problem?
- Ask: what would make you trust us?
- Offer the first trial

Every visit generates field intelligence — pain stack, trigger moment, current solution, trust fears, willingness to pay, trial interest, referrals. This data shapes the service before any platform is built.

Success Criteria

30-day (field investigation):

- 20+ structured home-pain interviews completed
- Domestic overwhelm confirmed as consistent pattern across segments
- Trust threshold documented: what it takes for each segment to say yes
- 3–5 founding homes committed to first trials
- Trigger moments mapped: top 3 moments when clients feel the pain most acutely

90-day (first trials):

- 10 Home Reset trials completed
- Post-trial NPS: 7+/10 ("My home felt lighter")
- 3+ founding homes converted to recurring monthly support
- Zero partner complaints about payment or treatment
- First subscription revenue flowing

6-month:

- 15–20 active monthly subscribers
- Recurring model validated: subscription preferred over on-demand (proven by conversion data)
- Worker retention: 100% of Partners still active
- 1–2 senior Partners identified for supervisor track
- Unit economics documented: cost per visit, average home value, churn rate

12-month:

- 50+ active subscribers
 - Hestia brand recognized without explanation in Zone 1 geography
 - Platform scoping begins (based on what the manual model has proven it needs)
 - Second geography scoped based on demand signals
-

What Hestia Does Not Say

Hestia's positioning is built as much by what it refuses as what it claims.

Do not say	Say instead
"We supply maids"	"We restore the home"
"We have workers available"	"We provide trusted home relief"
"We are an agency"	"We stay involved"
"We connect you to someone"	"We understand your home's pain point"
"Trust us"	"Let us prove the feeling first"
"We can do everything"	"We design support around your specific pain stack"
"Like Uber for maids"	"Hestia brings order, food, and care back into your home"

Scope

In scope for v1 (Founding Homes, Zone 1):

- Face-to-face domestic pain investigation — 20+ homes
- Home Reset Trial Package as flagship service
- WhatsApp-based booking and communication (no app)
- Manual supervision of all first visits by founder
- Post-visit feedback collection
- Partner training and profile management (manual)
- Zone 1: Kilimani, Lavington, or Westlands, Nairobi

Explicitly out of scope for v1:

- Mobile app or digital platform (platform follows the proven model)
 - Bulk institutional clients or commercial cleaning
 - Childcare, elder care, or gardening services
 - Zone 2 expansion
 - Formal insurance layer
 - Western Kenya worker pipeline (Phase 2 supply investment)
-

Vision

In five years, Hestia is the home-care operating system for urban East Africa.

The company starts as a service business — manual, human, deep — because the product is trust and relief, and trust cannot be automated before it is understood. The platform emerges from the manual model, carrying forward everything Hestia learns about how Kenyan households actually experience domestic overwhelm.

The worker who becomes a Hestia Home Care Partner in 2026 has, by 2030, a professional profile, a credit history built on Hestia earnings, NHIF contributions managed through the platform, and a career path that did not exist before. The household that books its first Home Reset trial in Kilimani in 2026 has not thought about domestic overwhelm in three years.

Hestia scales the same model into Uganda, Tanzania, Rwanda, and Ghana — because domestic overwhelm is not a Kenyan problem. It is a human problem. Everywhere life moves faster than the home can keep up, Hestia belongs.

"Hestia restores the home when life gets too busy."

The One-Line Flag

"Hestia restores the home when life gets too busy."

Or:

"Hestia helps busy Kenyans come home to order, clean clothes, and food that feels like home."